UX RESEARCH / USER PERSONA

Meet the SkillShare student

A campus skill-exchange app to learn, teach, and connect with peers for free.

NS

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College student · Age 20 (illustrative)

Learner, peer tutor, and campus community builder

PRIMARY GOAL	MOTIVATION	PLATFORM
Build practical skills	**Free peer learning**	**Mobile app**

“I want to learn useful skills from other students—and share what I already know—without paying for courses.”

ABOUT & BEHAVIOURS

- Studies full-time and uses a phone to discover learning opportunities.
- Knows a few skills and is willing to teach classmates informally.
- Prefers short, practical sessions and examples over long lectures.
- Wants to see a person’s skills and profile before reaching out.

GOALS

- Learn tools such as Python, Figma, Photoshop, or C++.
- Find students who can teach a skill he wants to improve.
- Share his own strengths and build confidence by teaching.
- Make new campus connections through common interests.

PAIN POINTS

- Paid courses can be difficult to afford.
- Hard to know which classmates can teach a specific skill.
- Nervous about messaging someone without shared context.
- Needs a clear way to distinguish skills to teach from skills to learn.

NEEDS FROM SKILLSHARE

- Simple sign-up and profile with college, bio, and skills.
- Separate “Skills You Can Teach” and “Skills You Want to Learn” lists.
- Search and filters for skills or people.
- Explore recommendations plus direct messages to arrange peer learning.

DESIGN OPPORTUNITY

Make skill exchange feel easy and safe. Help students list what they can teach and want to learn, discover relevant peers, and start a conversation with minimal friction.

KEY SUCCESS SIGNAL

A student can complete a profile, find a relevant peer, and send a first message without confusion.

Note: This is an illustrative persona based on the uploaded SkillShare app screens, not real user interview data.